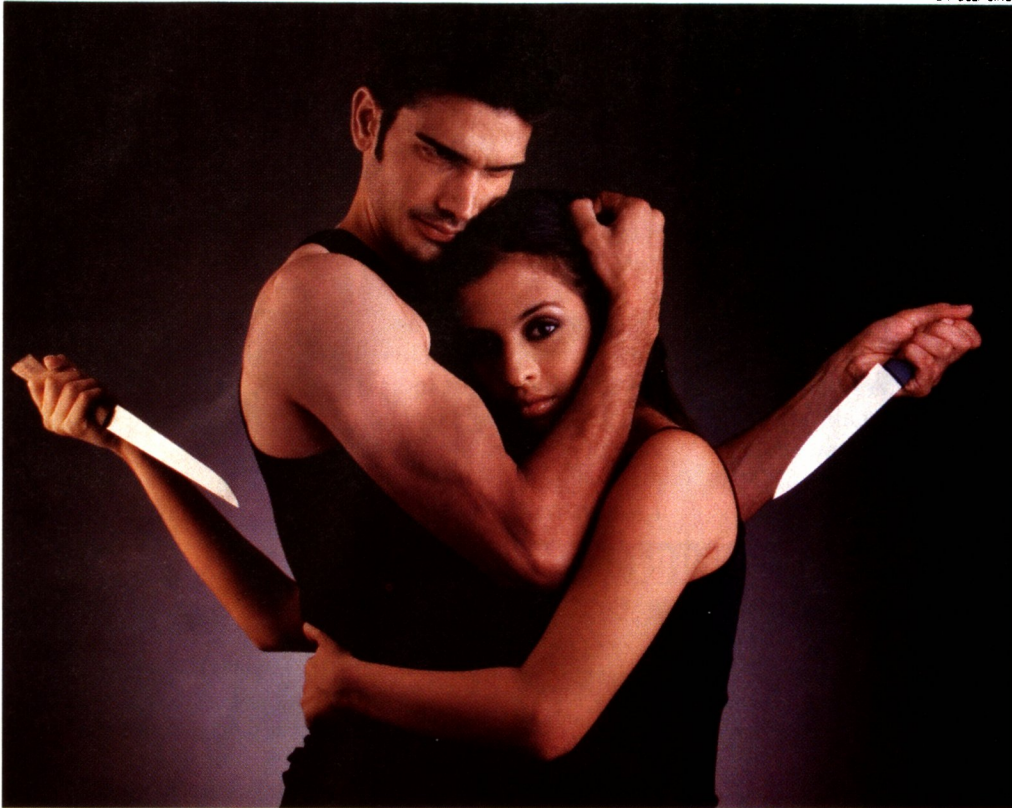


BANDEEP SINGH



"Crimes of Passion",
June 23, 2008

"The sole reason for increasing crimes is dissatisfaction with the self. The only way out of the rigmarole is self-analysis and fear of God."

SUBRAT KANUNGO, *Noida*

Partners in Crime

Blind imitation of the West has brought us to the present state of crisis in moral, social and individual values ("Crimes of Passion", June 23). We must stick to our ancestral Indian values and remember that a nest built on a weak branch can never survive.

R.J. KHURANA, *Bhopal*

It seems what men do, women overdo.

Promiscuity, as an offshoot of globalisation, is a very dangerous trend in a milieu like ours. Pre-nuptial agreements—like in the West—seem to hold the key to this malaise.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

Ekta Kapoor may well talk of women being sexually and financially independent as depicted in her television serials where extra-marital affairs are glorified. And, if she feels

that this is a rising, she would do better to know that it is actually a fall. Man is not woman's rival but her partner in life.

RAJIV CHOPRA, *Dehradun*

We should get back to the time-tested formula of married life. Also, the media should promote family values instead of glamorising Page 3 and initiating the youngsters into a fast-food life.

R.D. SINGH, *Leh*

The present generation is more selfish. They tend to be more physical, giving lust more importance, rather than focus on long-term relationships for marital bliss. Parents have a definite role to play in inculcating such subtle values in the children from a tender age.

K.R. VENKATA NARASIMHAN,
Bangalore

Crime passionnel (crime of passion) was regarded as a valid defence in France, the

original land of passionate relationships, till it was abandoned in the 1970s. It is still taken as a defence plea in several countries. Are we the newest country to enter this zone?

AMITABH THAKUR, *Lucknow*

The article is a timely reminder of our social degradation. Marriages, particularly in higher-ups in the society, often lack commitment and sincerity.

S. LAKSHMI, *on e-mail*

While it is commendable that the magazine is highlighting such issues, we have to be careful that the articles do not influence others to act in such a perverted manner.

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Caught in spiral growth and technical progress, we have lost our roots. Today's generation gets guided by their peers and not by their elders. Crimes of passion must be treated as the

rarest of rare cases and harsh punishment must be awarded to bring this scary trend under control.

MILIND KHER, *on e-mail*

The Wily Old Man

Arjun Singh had always wanted to be the prime minister of the country ("Knowledge Omission", June 23). His criticism of the Knowledge Commission's initiatives has only strengthened this fact. He must remember that he is well past his expiry date.

BAL GOVIND, *Bareilly*

Strong Medicine

Daiichi Sankyo's buyout of Ranbaxy reminds one of East India Company's entrance in the country ("Pill Deal", June 23). One hopes that unlike in the past, the pharmaceutical sector remains in Indian hands and that an Indian business house buys Ranbaxy back, maybe along with Daiichi.

M. KUMAR, *Delhi*